🎯 Innovation Hub – Q&A

1. Why not just use WhatsApp or social media groups?

- WhatsApp is good for casual chats but not structured for project management.
- Conversations get buried, there is no way to track progress, assign roles, or protect originality.
- Innovation Hub adds skills matching, project registration, and organized collaboration.

2. Why not use LinkedIn for student profiles?

- LinkedIn is for professional networking, not student project collaboration.
- No tools for team building, project tracking, or interdisciplinary innovation.
- Innovation Hub lets students experiment safely and showcase projects in an academic-focused space.

3. Why not use Microsoft Teams?

- Microsoft Teams is powerful but require licenses and is built for corporate workflows.
- Too heavy for students, lacks project showcase directories and originality protection.
- Innovation Hub is lightweight, student-friendly, and tailored to LSU.

4. How will you ensure students use the platform?

- It's user-friendly and relevant: students can showcase skills, find teammates, and protect ideas.
- Directly connected to employability, entrepreneurship, and industry exposure.

5. What makes Innovation Hub different from existing tools?

- Purpose-built for LSU: interdisciplinary collaboration, originality protection, skills matching, commercialization pathways.

- Existing tools don’t combine these features in one place.

6. How will projects be protected from plagiarism or idea theft?

- Every project gets a unique identifier and timestamp upon registration.
- Ensures originality and protects intellectual property.

7. What’s the benefit for the university?

- Revenue generation through commercialization.
- Stronger industry partnerships and improved student employability.
- Enhanced institutional reputation as a leader in innovation.

8. How will you sustain the platform financially?

- Built on open-source tools (low cost).
- Revenue streams: industry-funded projects, paid access for external users, commercialization, alumni/donor engagement.

9. What outcomes do you expect?

- A vibrant community of innovators.
- Increased interdisciplinary collaboration.
- Improved employability and entrepreneurship skills.
- Potential student-led startups.

10. Why focus on engineering students first?

- Engineering projects are complex and interdisciplinary, making them a strong pilot group.
- Once proven effective, the platform can expand to other faculties.

Potential Questions & Suggested Answers

Q1: "This sounds like a lot of existing platforms. Why build a new one when students can just use GitHub, LinkedIn, or Discord? What's the real difference?"

(The question "Why not use existing tools?")

Answer: "That's a very fair question. While general-purpose tools are great, they create a fragmented experience that works *against* our goal of breaking down silos.

- GitHub is excellent for coders, but what about Mechatronics or Business students? They get left out.
- LinkedIn is for your polished, final profile, not for brainstorming rough, early-stage project ideas with strangers on campus.
- Discord/WhatsApp are great for chatting, but they're chaotic. Ideas get lost, and there's no structure to build a team or manage a project from start to finish.

The Innovation Hub is different because it's a unified, purpose-built ecosystem. It combines skill discovery, team formation, project management, and a formal registration system in one place. It's not just another tool; it's a central 'campus square' designed specifically for the collaborative workflow of *our* students, across *all* faculties."

Q2: "How will you ensure students actually use it? Many university platforms are launched and then become ghost towns."

(The "User adoption" question)

Answer: "Adoption is our primary success metric, and we've planned for it from the start. We're not just building a platform; we're building a community. Our strategy has three pillars:

1. Integration with Curriculum: We'll work with lecturers to encourage its use for group project formation and as a place to document project-based assessments.
2. Incentivizing Participation: We'll highlight successful projects and teams through university communications. The 'Project Registration' feature also provides a tangible benefit: official recognition and a timestamp to protect an idea's originality, which is a huge motivator.
3. Bottom-Up Engagement: We start with a pilot group of motivated students from clubs and societies (like the Programming Club or Engineering Society) to create

initial activity and make the platform the 'place to be' for innovation before a wider rollout."

Q3: "Won't this increase the workload for already busy lecturers and staff? Who will moderate this?"

(The "Sustainability and Moderation" question)

Answer: "The core principle of the Innovation Hub is student-led collaboration. The day-to-day activities creating projects, building teams, discussing ideas—are designed to be entirely student-driven.

The primary role for staff, like our supervisor Mr. Dovi, is strategic guidance and oversight. The main administrative task is the 'Project Registration' at the end, which is a high-value, low-volume task that provides an official university stamp. By using open-source tools and a lean model, we keep the platform sustainable without placing a significant burden on staff."

Q4: "How will you handle intellectual property (IP)? If a student creates something great on the platform, who owns it?"

(The "Intellectual Property" question)

Answer: "This is a crucial point for fostering trust and entrepreneurship. The platform itself is designed to encourage innovation, and our recommendation would be for the university to establish a clear and fair IP policy alongside the platform's launch.

A modern, attractive policy for students would be a shared ownership model. For example, the student team retains the rights to their invention, while the university gets a percentage of any future royalties or a non-exclusive license to use the project for educational and research purposes. This incentivizes students to innovate while also creating a potential revenue stream for the university, as mentioned in our benefits. The platform's 'Project Registration' feature would be the official first step in documenting that IP."

Q5: "The budget is very low, which is good, but what about long-term costs? Hosting, maintenance, and potential scaling?"

(The "Long-term viability" question)

Answer: "You're right to look at the long term. The initial $120 budget proves we can build a powerful Minimum Viable Product (MVP) sustainably using open-source tools.

Our plan is that the platform should pay for itself. As outlined in our 'How this will benefit LSU' section, the revenue generated from successful projects, whether through licensing, industry partnerships, or even small sponsorship deals, will be reinvested into the platform's maintenance, hosting, and future development. The Innovation Hub is designed not as a cost center, but as a long-term, self-sustaining asset for the university."

These answers should help you and your team feel confident and well prepared. Good luck with your presentation